

FAFSA Document Checklist

FOR THE PARENT

Everything you need in front of you before opening the form. Families abandon the FAFSA halfway through because a document is upstairs, and then do not come back to it.

When: Before you sit down to file — gather first, file second

For the student

- ☐ Social Security number (or Alien Registration number)
- ☐ FSA ID — created by the student, in the student's own email
- ☐ Driver's licence, if they have one
- ☐ Tax return for the relevant year, if they filed
- ☐ Records of untaxed income
- ☐ Balances of savings and checking accounts
- ☐ List of colleges to send it to

For the parent or parents who must report

- ☐ Social Security number
- ☐ FSA ID — separate from the student's, in the parent's own email
- ☐ Tax return and W-2s for the relevant year
- ☐ Records of child support received
- ☐ Current balances of cash, savings and checking
- ☐ Value of investments and any business or farm assets

Which parent reports? — for separated and divorced families

The parent who provided the most financial support during the last 12 months is the one who reports, regardless of who has custody or who claims the student on taxes. If that parent has remarried, the stepparent's information is required too. Write down who that is before you start, so you are not deciding it mid-form.

The reporting parent in our case is:

Dates

The day we filed

Confirmation number

Earliest college deadline

State deadline

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ File as early as you can. Some aid is first-come, first-served and simply runs out.
- ◆ The FAFSA is free. Any site charging you to file it is not the FAFSA.
- ◆ Filing costs nothing and rules nothing out. File even if you are sure you will not qualify.